

i'm scared that my future is now dead in the water thanks to ai.

Posted by u/TheGhostGuyMan • • 0 points • 38 comments

i'm going to make this as brief as possible.

i'm young. still in high school, to be specific. for almost five years now, i've wanted to peruse a career in art and writing. for five years, i've spent hours of my life working on stories. for five years, i've developed an almost unyielding devotion to art.

i've clung onto this passion for art even while being made fun of by those in my generation who mock art on a day to day basis and kill their attention spans watching edgy american propaganda edits on tic tok or instagram reels. i've been questioned by so many people for my passions and i've struggled to actually make authentic friends due to having difficulties in finding people who share my same passions (fyi: I do have friends, so i'm not entirely alone, although they live on the other side of the country because my family moved recently. the only times i interact with these friends is through discord, and i'm horribly ashamed of it.)

yet through it all, i always thought that if i just kept going and kept marching through it, that i'd persevere and make it out on top. until today, when a new image ai software was announced and had arguably the most realistic ai generated images i've ever seen.

i don't know. i just don't know anything anymore. i can't believe this is happening to me and to so many other people. i'm genuinely doubting my future and my dreams. how is a satisfying life possible in a world where you can't even look at a photo of a couple smiling without needing to conduct an hours worth of research into wether or not it's real? how? how is anything possible when governments can exploit this to inflict harm among their populous?

it's terrifying and i feel like it's all over and i just don't know how to find anything good from this situation.

i've heard that ai is a bubble but at where we are now, does it even matter? i fear it's very clear who the victors are and that shakes me to my very core. my generation (alpha) is too lazy and brainwashed to do anything meaningful to combat this. they trash art regularly, and i see it daily.

i utterly despise pessimism with a burning passion, but after today, i don't know. why is this

the world i have to live in? why do i have to experience the rise of ai, authoritarianism, and global warming? i'm a sophomore, for fucks sake, i should be excited for the future.

i deeply apologize if this isn't the most coherent or cohesive. i have a lot on my mind and i need to get it out somehow.

Comments

u/UniverseGlory7866 • 1 points • 2025-12-01 21:52 UTC

There are no successful AI driven projects at anywhere close to the scale of primarily human made media.

AI is a tool, in the sense that it can *help* you, like filling in that little gap in the background because you erased something unsightly. Or being an information repository when you need guidance.

Any attempts at using it as a full blown method of creation have failed because the audience of people that would bother to interact with a non-mega popular brand doesn't like AI. You don't have access to the "general" audience of people that buy each NBA or CoD and play for an hour on weekends. They aren't invested consumers. They don't have the kind of eyes that want to see non corporate level media.

Despite all the money, all the effort, all the systems used to force AI imagery into our world, it's received no accolades, no fame, no status. It's Roko's Basilisk. Look at video games. None of the game of the year nominees are AI driven media. They beg us to remove AI labels because they aren't proud of being AI.

AI "art" isn't your enemy. It's far too weak to be any actual competition. Keep walking. Your path is only dark from a distance.

u/PP_Nickelnuts • 1 points • 2025-12-01 05:24 UTC

Sucks. You most likely would have wound up making a living doing art. Sucks you were born too late

u/Overall_Cat_145 • 1 points • 2025-11-30 01:08 UTC

If you're an artist, you can continue making art AI or no AI, first thing is AI art looks like shit anyways, it is very obvious when something is human or slop, secondly, art is never going to make money or be an occupation, it is always a hobby, and if you make good art, well people would rather look at it than AI art. We are living in one of the best times in history, never have we had such good conditions as we have today, never have we had such high moral standards as today, once you look at the bright side you will realize how amazing our situation is.

u/The_Lonely_Optimist • 1 points • 2026-01-02 01:55 UTC

The only AI art you know is AI slop are the bad ones. You've likely seen quite a bit of ai content by now that was so believable you didn't if even realize it was ai.

u/ChaseTheRedDot • 1 points • 2025-11-30 00:46 UTC

Learn how to leverage AI into your creative workflow. It's a tool. Use it. Or lose job opportunities to other creatives who take the time to learn.

u/Apprehensive_Cow8695 • 1 points • 2025-11-29 16:51 UTC

im an ai bro but a job in art was hard to get regardless and even harder to keep with relatively low salaries... its much better as a hobby than a job but if u must be an artist when youre older id say learn how to incorporate ai to make your drawings easier (such as using it for shading if you dont feel like it or using it for a simple background). i know most artists hate the idea of using ai but corporations will force it regardless to enhance productivity

anyway youre not cooked and this is coming from someone who is surrounded by ai almost 24/7 as i have a youtube channel focused on it, ai models arent specific enough to do it all so just learn to use ai to enhance your art and youre all good (you will actually be ahead of the curve this way)

it sucks you have to use ai but it is what it is

u/Familiar-Scene9533 • 1 points • 2025-11-27 21:12 UTC

It's okay to feel this way—it's enough that art brings you a bit of joy.

u/Borckle • 1 points • 2025-11-27 18:18 UTC

There are benefits to hobbies. They help you expand your skills and can give you an 'in' for certain groups/meetups. So pursuing your likes isn't a waste. But you should still be focussing on things that can make you employable. The things society needs and pays for is not usually the things we want to do.

u/Vynzael • 1 points • 2025-11-27 15:41 UTC

in the same boat; i'm 18, been a self-taught programmer since 13, put in a ton of effort without relying on ai, seeing people make better things all made by ai can be pretty demotivating

but, there'll always be a market for something human made; the more genai permeates the internet, the more people will get fatigued by it and want something human instead

u/kynoid • 1 points • 2025-11-27 14:22 UTC

there is still a good chance youd find a good place for your Art.

My feeling is, that genuine Art will soon rise in value, because yeah most people who love art and would even hang pieces on their walls will understand the difference.

As for companies or book authors there are definetly those that value real art and who will hire artists and be it only for their PR/image. A bit like GMO free and environmentally friendly or fair traded products are still a thing although there are cheaper options.

u/Fujinn981 • 1 points • 2025-11-27 14:19 UTC

Computers are better at chess than humans. Have been for decades. We don't watch computers play chess. We watch humans play chess. This isn't a direct comparison to AI, since AI sucks at art, but the principle applies. People don't want AI art. They want human art, human art is interesting. AI art is soulless.

Aside from that, AI is not profitable. When the bubble goes and investment starts to dry which is where we're already headed, it won't be as accessible anymore. AI slop will largely vanish as the ability to make it will be behind exorbitant paywalls. The technology itself is running into increasingly expensive diminishing returns. It's not going to be able to take away anyone's future.

Rather a person is an artist, programmer, writer, etc, etc. There's a place for you in the future. AI is nothing but a false promise pushed by asshat grifters.